

Biology Lessons





About the Course

Alveary High School Biology guides students through all major topics in the discipline. Based on the second edition of Novare General Biology, the Alveary course incorporates living engagement and special attention to citizenship, problem-solving, and communication skills for a complete Charlotte Mason science course. Members that already have the first edition of the text should be sure to keep their lesson plans for future use!

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Biology



Placement & Combining Tips

There are no specific prerequisites or concurrents for this course, but there are a number of complex ideas that are difficult without some prior experience. A course with some exposure to basic chemistry is recommended before enrollment in Biology.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
10-12+	Biology Lessons 5 times/week 45 min	The Biology Coloring Book The Spirit of the Rainforest General Biology, 2nd Edition The Fool and the Heretic

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Biology				
Biology Lessons	Biology Lessons Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 9-12	Biology Lessons	Biology Lessons Nature Notebook: Grades 9-12	Biology Lessons Biology Labs



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Biology Lessons

☐ Carve out time to continue or establish the regular habit of spending time in nature, including the use of a nature journal, as appropriate.

☐ Obtain materials from the supply lists.

☐ Plan for discussion and engagement. Teachers who do not feel that they can discuss the subject of this course with students should plan to either pre-read the material or complete the

course alongside their students. Expertise is not necessary, but discussion is as important in math and science as in history and literature.

☐ Labs/activities are presented in a fully integrated state in which they are connected to the lessons. To use them in this way, it is helpful for the lab to be scheduled after the 5th lesson. If your lab time is earlier in the week and you will find it difficult to be flexible, plan to delay the start of the lesson schedule so that lab day occurs after the 5th lesson. For example, if your lab time is on Tuesday, you might begin lesson 1 on Wednesday of the first week of school rather than on Monday. Those wanting to use the labs/activities on a more flexible schedule can do so, but should be ready and able to adjust lesson connections.

☐ Select a science book from the Alveary bookshelf for personal reading time, as appropriate.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Biology Lessons

☐ Gather household items, typically easy for students to scavenge or teachers to obtain locally:

- any living plant specimen found nearby
- any non-living specimen
- red onion (Term 1)
- kitchen knife
- distilled or deionized water
- paper towels
- lamp or bright light
- strawberries (Term 1)
- salt
- a variety of colors of small Lego bricks
- computer access
- stopwatch, such as those found on most electronic devices
- cereal O's
- small bread cubes or mini marshmallows
- chopsticks
- fork

Reminders

Biology Lessons

☐ Note that Lab in week 5 calls for red onions and Lab in week 8 for strawberries. Make a note in your calendar if you will need to purchase these closer to the appropriate time. Refer to the lab book for more details.

☐ Note that the Keys (provided in Quick Links) are for the 1st edition. The overall content in the two editions is very similar, but the numbering of chapters is slightly different, especially as learners reach Term 3. When using the Keys, teachers should attend to the topics rather than relying on the numbering.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Biology Lessons



The Biology Coloring Book



The Spirit of the Rainforest



General Biology, 2nd Edition



The Fool and the Heretic



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Biology Lessons

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [All Keys and Sample Answers \(1st edition, see reminder in header\)](#)
- ∞ [Homework Help for HS Science Students](#)
- ∞ [Contact Us for Teachers](#)
- ∞ [Alveary Bookshelf](#)
- ∞ [John Muir Laws • Nature Journaling Resources](#)
- ∞ [Seek app from iNaturalist](#)
- ∞ [SkyView Lite for iOS](#)
- ∞ [SkyView Lite for Android](#)
- ∞ [Lab Notebook Examples](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Biology Lab Book](#)
- ∞ [AmScope Original Student Slide Key](#)

Biology Lessons

How To Approach



Introduce

- Learners begin each lesson with their existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to consider what learners think about it, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap.
- Take note of the chapter or section heading, and consider how the day's topic connects back to prior topic(s).
- Look back as needed. The outline of the book and even of the chapter is helpful in drawing out and connecting ideas. Learners practice making these connections as they proceed through the book.



Read

- Read or do as instructed in the lessons. Teachers should note any Teacher Tips provided.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- As they read, learners record ideas in a notebook or binder using outlines, diagrams, graphic organizers, or other methods (or a combination of methods) that suit them. These recordings can be a helpful mechanism for remembering or a mini-narration to support understanding.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try reading over the passage again, studying a picture or diagram, connecting the idea to something from real life, or practicing chapter exercises. The lab book further supports major concepts from the text.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by explaining a concept, describing an object, retelling events, etc. Consider what the point of the lesson is before deciding what to do with it.
- Learners may use words, pictures, models, graphics, etc, to process and convey ideas in their own way.



Discuss

- Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.
- Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans (or even lab books) to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. Alternatively, many of these can be used for composition, depending on the needs of the learner and the instructional goals of the teacher.
- Note that learners may need to spend more than the allotted time engaging with or even repeating a lesson before moving on or as reinforcement at a later time. Adjust the pace as needed to feed the learner.
- Notice if there are any dates to keep for the Book of Centuries or quotes for the Commonplace Book.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc, depending on learner needs and interest.
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SAMPLE

Biology Lessons

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 1

Materials: General Biology

PREP: Be sure you have read the Course Notes and Planning and Prep.

→ INTRODUCTION

In General Biology, much of your previous experience in science comes together. You will notice some familiar ideas and will explore many of them with greater depth than ever before. As you work through the course, note the outline of ideas in the text and the main ideas in each section, and record any definitions and important points. You should take a few minutes to review your notes at least weekly throughout the year.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read the introduction to Ch.1 and the Objectives for Section 1.1. Then read to the end of Section 1.1, noting important terms and their definitions, copying any helpful diagrams, and recording interesting or important points. You will do this as you continue throughout the course. Note that the author of this series uses the term "Cycle of Scientific Enterprise" to refer to the process that is the Scientific Method (1.1.3). If you have completed previous levels of Alveary Science and have a working understanding of the Scientific Method from lab, you may quickly skim section 1.1.3 or simply review the process in Figure 1.6.

• PLAN WEEKLY

- ☐ nature walk - record observations
- ☐ science free read

WEEK 1 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 2

Materials: General Biology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Refer to the Objectives for Section 1.2 at the beginning of the chapter. Then read Section 1.2.1 - 1.2.2.

• PLAN WEEKLY

- ☐ nature walk - record observations
- ☐ science free read

WEEK 1 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 3

Materials: General Biology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Section 1.2.3 - 1.2.7

WEEK 1 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 4

Materials: General Biology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Refer to the Objectives for Section 1.3 at the beginning of the chapter. Then, finish Ch.1 by reading section 1.3. Use any time remaining to begin the review exercises at the end of the chapter. You may answer these orally, in writing, or with pictures. If unsure about any of them, refer back to the appropriate section to reread or find the answer.

WEEK 1 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 5

Materials: General Biology

→ PRACTICE

Continue working through the review exercises at the end of Ch.1.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 60m Biology Lessons - Lesson 6

Observing Living and Nonliving Things

Materials: High School Biology Lab Book and materials listed within, and The Biology Coloring Book

PREP: Read Student/Teacher Tip

→ LAB DAY

Complete Lab 1. Color plate 1 in your coloring book, as time permits.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

Note that there are 3 activity days next week: Lessons 7-9.

Two of these require outdoor work. You may move Week 2 to accommodate the weather, as needed. If you need to adjust for a rainy day in your forecast for the week, then Lesson 7 can be moved to another day of the week.

WEEK 2 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 7

Materials: Article link

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: In the Laboratory

Study any natural object, recording what you see. When you think you have noticed all that you can, try to observe more. What else can you see? You may use field guides, handbooks, etc., to aid your study today, if desired.

WEEK 2 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 8

Materials: Article links

→ INTRO

A BioBlitz is a biological inventory where scientists find and identify as many species as possible in a specific area during a specific time. If you'd like to learn more about it, you can read the National Geographic article linked. A bigger question is why scientists would take such an inventory, however. To understand that, read the article on current events from Science News Explores.

∞ Article Link: BioBlitz

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read the article entitled, "Some Spikes in Malaria Cases May Be Due to Amphibian Die-off" from Science News Explores

∞ Article Link: Some spikes in malaria

→ FIELDWORK

Your BioBlitz will last for 1 day, so choose your area carefully based on how many scientists will be keeping inventory and what you plan to record. You may inventory all species or focus on only one type of object (e.g., plants, insects, birds, etc.). You will only briefly observe, identify, and document each object in your lab notebook - you will not journal on individuals as in Lab 1. Today, decide what you will inventory and plan how you will collect your BioBlitz data. Collect any special materials or equipment that you might need, such as a magnifier or field guide. Then, begin by writing an introductory narration in your notebook and getting an overview of the area. You might want to sketch a landscape or make a map of the area, noting any landmarks.

WEEK 2 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 9

Materials: anything needed for data collection

→ FIELDWORK

Collect your BioBlitz data.



Term 1

WEEK 2 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 10

Materials: graph paper or spreadsheet

→ DATA ANALYSIS

Analyze your BioBlitz data. Do you want to make a table or chart of the data? How can you best represent what you noticed? Do you think your data would be different in a different location or time of year? How could you find out?

WEEK 2 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 11

Materials: Links

→ REPORT WRITING

Write a report indicating the results of your BioBlitz. Your report should have an Introduction explaining the purpose of the field study, a Procedure explaining your location and time, any methods (e.g., sample collection, identification, etc.), and any special equipment used in your study, Results indicating your findings, and Analysis and Conclusions explaining interesting observations, introducing any questions, and sharing whatever conclusions you came to. There is an example in the link. The article links we started with are also provided if you want to refer back to them. You may work on this report during Lesson 12, as well.

∞ Link: Sample Lab Report

∞ Article Link: BioBlitz

∞ Article Link: Some spikes in malaria

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

Note that there are 3 activity days next week: Lessons 7-9. Two of these require outdoor work. You may move Week 2 to accommodate the weather, as needed. If you need to adjust for a rainy day in your forecast for the week, then Lesson 7 can be moved to another day of the week.

WEEK 2 60m Biology Lessons - Lesson 12

Materials: Report from previous lesson

→ REPORT WRITING

Complete your report. Review and edit it to make improvements before turning it in. While editing, be sure you have used complete sentences and avoid using the first person. In technical writing, such as this, the sentence "I tied the string to the end of the meter stick" should be rephrased, "The string was tied to the end of the meter stick."

WEEK 3 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 13

Materials: General Biology

→ NOTE

If you completed Introductory Chemistry, you may find that much of Ch.2 is a review with some application to biological systems. If you have not yet completed Introductory Chemistry, you may need to take this chapter more slowly.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read the introduction to Ch.2 and the Objectives for Section 2.1. Note important terms and their definitions, copy any helpful diagrams, and record any interesting or important points.

Then read sections 2.1.1 - 2.1.2, working the examples in the text. Always work the examples in the text as you read because these help to ensure understanding.

If you have time remaining, begin to work through the Exercises at the end of the chapter for 2.1. For general practice and review, note that

● PLAN WEEKLY

- ☐ nature walk - record observations
- ☐ science free read

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

coloring plates 4-21 cover the material in Ch.2. You can use any plates like these that are not scheduled when you need some extra practice or review.

WEEK 3 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 14

Materials: General Biology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Section 2.1.3. Read and copy any diagrams that you think are helpful to your understanding.

Then, continue work on the Exercises for Section 2.1, as time permits.

• PLAN WEEKLY

- ☐ nature walk - record observations
- ☐ science free read

WEEK 3 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 15

Materials: General Biology

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Refer to the Objectives for Section 2.2 at the beginning of the chapter. Read 2.2 and copy any diagrams that you think are helpful to your understanding.

Then work on the Exercises for Section 2.2, as time permits.

★ TEACHER TIP

Learners encounter a lot more technical content at this disciplinary stage. If they do not remember or fully understand every detail, that is okay. Can they talk about it and explain their thinking? Do they know how to go back and find what they need if they need it? Are they able to lean into the uncertainty with curiosity and a habit of problem-solving? If you are unsure about their progress, reach out through Contact Us.

WEEK 3 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 16

Materials: General Biology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Refer to the Objectives for Section 2.3 at the beginning of the chapter. Read sections 2.3.1 - 2.3.2

Then work on the Exercises for Section 2.3, as time permits.

★ STUDENT REMINDER

Don't forget to use Homework Help in your Quick Links if you need any help or to offer a thought for discussion.

WEEK 3 45m Biology Lessons - Lesson 17

Materials: General Biology

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Section 2.3

Then work on the Exercises for Section 2.3, as time permits.

WEEK 3 60m Biology Lessons - Lesson 18

Collecting Properties of Water

Materials: High School Biology Lab Book and materials listed within

→ LAB DAY

Begin Lab 2.